
FAQ and Objection Handling — For When the Hard Questions Come

This is your sparring partner. Read it before the Bishop meeting so that no question catches you flat. Each one gives you the honest short answer to say out loud, and a sentence of why it's true. The golden rule under all of them: when a question is pointed, don't get defensive — get honest. Defensiveness reads as "he's hiding something"; calm honesty reads as "he's thought about this." You have thought about this.

“Is this an official Church app?”

No — and it tells everyone so, every time it opens, with a written line that says it's “not officially affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by any church.” It's an independent app I built as a member. I'd never want anyone to mistake it for something the Church put out.

“Then why are you bringing it to me?”

Because even though it's not a Church product, it touches sacred things and it's meant to help bring people to Christ — so I want it done under priesthood counsel, not off on my own. I'm not asking you to endorse it. I'm asking for your blessing to let a few trusted brethren test it and tell me honestly what they see.

“Is it appropriate to use AI for something spiritual?”

The Church spoke to this directly in December 2025, when the General Handbook added guidance on AI. It says to use AI in positive, uplifting ways, that AI can never replace divine inspiration or real relationships, and that it should support — not supplant — a person's connection with God. That's the exact standard the app is built to. It reminds every user, every time, that it's not God, can't answer a prayer, and that they should pray to Heavenly Father directly. It's anchored in Elder Gong's own words that AI “is not God and cannot be God.”

“Could the AI teach false doctrine?”

That's the honest risk with any AI, and I won't pretend it's impossible — which is exactly why I want priesthood holders testing it and flagging anything that feels off. By design it only ministers from the Bible and the goodness of God most people already accept. It will not bring up the Restoration, Joseph Smith, or the Book of Mormon unless the person reaches for it and gives permission first. And nothing in it is presented as official Church doctrine.

“Isn't it dishonest to hide that it's an LDS app until later?”

It never hides it. The moment anyone asks who made it or whether it's an LDS app, it answers immediately and truthfully — it's instructed never to deny or dodge that. What it doesn't do is *open* with a sales pitch, for the same reason the Savior didn't begin by announcing “I am the Messiah, join my church.” He told stories, healed, asked questions, and let people come to know Him. The app follows that pattern — and it asks the person's permission before ever introducing the restored gospel, and drops it entirely if they say no.

“Are you trying to manipulate people into joining the Church?”

No. Two things make that impossible by design. First, it never lies about what it is — full disclosure the instant anyone asks. Second, it leaves everyone completely free; its written rule is literally “Jesus let the rich young ruler walk away, so do you.” It measures success as a person being “truly met, unpressured, and free” — whether or not they ever join anything. That’s the Handbook’s own standard for missionary work, too.

“What happens to what people tell it? Is their privacy protected?”

It collects very little. People sign in anonymously — no name, no email, no account required. If someone chooses to message a real person, that’s stored tied only to an anonymous ID, and they can only ever see their own conversation. The app even shows people what it has noticed about them and lets them delete it. There’s a published privacy policy. The honest caveat: the conversation is processed by an outside AI provider and the messages are stored in a standard cloud database — normal for an app, but real, so I keep what’s collected to a minimum.

“What if someone in real crisis uses it — someone suicidal?”

It has a deliberate crisis protocol. If someone signals despair or self-harm, it’s instructed to lead with presence — just being with them — rather than a cold hand-off, to never act as a therapist or diagnose, to gently offer a real person, and in the U.S., when there’s sign of immediate danger, to surface the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline. I thought hard about the worst moments, not just the easy ones.

“Does this replace the missionaries?”

Not at all. It’s one member living ‘love, share, invite,’ and it keeps a real person one tap away at every step. The long-term hope is actually to have real missionaries woven into it down the road. Right now it just helps me do what every member is asked to do — invite people toward Christ — and hand them to a real person whenever they want one.

“Who’s responding when someone wants to talk to a real person?”

Right now, me. I review the conversations and respond. As it grows, the vision is a small team of trusted members, and eventually real missionaries. But nothing about that is hidden — the app calls it “the admin team,” and a person always knows a human is available.

“What if I’m not comfortable with it?”

Then I want to hear exactly what gives you pause, and I’ll take it seriously — that’s the whole reason I came to you first instead of just launching it. If it’s a “not yet” or a “change this first,” that’s a good outcome, not a rejection. I’d rather do this slowly and right than fast and wrong.

“What do you actually need from me today?”

Just your blessing for me to invite a few priesthood holders to test it for a couple of weeks and give me honest feedback. That’s the whole ask. And if you’d like, I’d love to put it on your own phone so you can try it yourself first — it takes about two minutes.

THE THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER IN THE ROOM

First, **keep the ask small** — you want a blessing to run a quiet test, nothing bigger. Second, **never deny a weakness; name it and show how you’ve handled it** — that’s what separates trustworthy from salesy. Third, **let silence sit** after he reads the brochure; don’t fill it. A leader who’s given room to think his own way to “yes” owns that yes far more than one who was talked into it.